

Full-stack development (web and cloud applications)

Key languages and frameworks: JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Next.js, Node.js, GraphQL

Job titles:

- Full-stack developer
- Front-end engineer
- Web application developer
- Software engineer (product)

The modern developer is expected to manage both client and server logic, working with agile teams to deliver fast and responsive web apps.

What's hot in 2025:

- Serverless architecture (Vercel, Netlify, AWS Lambda)
- Progressive Web Apps (PWAs)
- TypeScript adoption in enterprise-grade applications

Career path insight: Full-stack developers often transition into technical leadership roles, such as software architects or product engineering leads.

Cloud computing and DevOps

Key skills: Go, Python, Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, CI/CD pipelines

Job titles:

- DevOps engineer
- Cloud infrastructure engineer
- Site reliability engineer (SRE)
- Platform engineer

As cloud adoption matures, companies seek engineers who can design resilient infrastructure, automate deployment, and ensure high uptime.

What's hot in 2025:

- GitOps and Infrastructure as Code (IaC)
- Observability and incident response (Grafana, Prometheus)
- Cloud FinOps (cost optimisation engineering)

Career path insight: Cloud professionals earn an average of 20%–40% higher salaries, especially with certifications in AWS, Azure, or Google Cloud.

Cybersecurity and secure coding

Key languages: C, C++, Python, Rust, Bash

Job titles:

- Security software engineer
- Ethical hacker/Penetration tester
- Application security analyst
- DevSecOps engineer

As attacks become more sophisticated, developers are being pulled into security roles—not just to patch bugs, but to architect secure-by-design systems.

What's hot in 2025:

- Zero trust architecture
- Secure cloud storage encryption
- Vulnerability scanning with AI tools

Career path insight: Demand for security engineers is expected to grow 3x faster than traditional IT roles by 2026 (US Bureau of Labor Statistics).

Mobile development

Key languages: Kotlin, Swift, Dart (Flutter), React Native

Job titles:

- iOS/Android developer
- Mobile app engineer
- Cross-platform developer
- Flutter developer

With more users relying on mobile-first experiences, demand is soaring for developers who can optimise apps for performance, battery, and UX.

What's hot in 2025:

- Flutter 3.0 dominance in cross-platform development
- Integration with wearables and IoT devices
- On-device AI for personalised experiences

Career path insight: Top-tier mobile developers often freelance or build SaaS apps, making this field ideal for both employment and entrepreneurship.

Data engineering and Big Data programming

Key tools: SQL, Apache Spark, Kafka, Airflow, Scala, Python

Job titles:

- Data engineer
- Analytics engineer
- ETL developer
- Platform data architect

Data engineers build the backbone of data pipelines and infrastructure, ensuring businesses have clean, reliable, and accessible data.

What's hot in 2025:

- Real-time analytics pipelines
- DataOps and metadata management
- Data Mesh architecture in large enterprises

Career path insight: Data engineering roles command higher salaries than traditional BI, often rivalling software engineering in senior positions.

Low-code/No-code and API integration

Key platforms: Zapier, Retool, Microsoft Power Apps, Airtable, Bubble

Job titles:

- Automation developer
- Technical business analyst